Patina — media background

Background edition · 11 September 2026 · Website and founding community; public app and marketplace pre-launch.

Madison-founded Patina opens a place in its Founding Circle

The Living Study website introduces Leah and Kody Kochaver's approach to furniture discovery, with an invitation to help shape what comes next.

MADISON, Wisconsin — Patina's redesigned website is live, inviting people who care about their homes to join a founding community of up to 200 members. Founded by Leah and Kody Kochaver, Patina is developing a designer-taught furniture platform that brings a designer's judgment, a maker's care, and the person living with the furniture into the same conversation.

The website, called the Living Study, moves through a room, a study of materials, and the making process. Its connected motion and warm material palette reflect the founders' intention for Patina: tools that feel at home in the creative process. The familiar Patina Strata remains part of the identity.

Leah leads Design & Experience at Patina and runs Middle West Studio, her interior-design practice. Her work begins with understanding how a person lives and what will make a room feel like theirs. Kody leads Technology & Product. He is building Patina in response to a gap he sees in existing tools, which can feel sterile and disconnected from creative work.

Together, the founders are developing a way for people to find furniture that belongs in their space, with a path to working with a designer when they want more guidance. The app and marketplace are still pre-launch. The website introduces the direction and the people behind it; public app access and marketplace purchasing are not yet available.

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e gives early members a part in that work. Members receive a welcome from
ne studio, monthly questions that invite their input, and first access when

the app launches. Founding status is permanent, and members can choose to be recognized at launch. The 200-member limit is the program's cap, not a count of remaining places.

Initial outreach begins with Leah's client relationships and Madison-area conversations, followed by selective outreach along the Chicago–Madison–Minneapolis corridor. Founding Circle membership has no geographic restriction.

There are also dedicated invitations for working interior designers and furniture makers. The Founding 50 invites designers to help shape the platform; Patina is seeking 15 Founding Makers. Applications are reviewed by Kody with Leah. The maker program follows a principle of craft over volume, with no sponsored placements or pay-to-play.

Explore the Living Study at patina.cloud and Join the Founding Circle. Designers can explore the Founding 50, and makers can learn about partnering.

About Patina

Founded in Madison, Wisconsin, in 2023 by Leah and Kody Kochaver, Patina is developing a designer-taught furniture platform. Its aim is to put a great designer's eye within reach and create a path from personal discovery to working with a designer. The app and marketplace are pre-launch. Where Time Adds Value.

Media contact

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Fact sheet

Item	Confirmed information
Brand	Patina
Signature	Where Time Adds Value.
Founded	2023, in Madison, Wisconsin
Founders	Leah Kochaver and Kody Kochaver
	Co-Founder, Design & Experience

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Kody's role	Co-Founder, Technology & Product
Available now	Living Study website; Founding Circle enrollment; designer and maker application paths
Product stage	Public app and marketplace are pre-launch
Product direction	Furniture discovery guided by working designers, with a path to deeper design guidance
Consumer invitation	Join the Founding Circle — program cap of 200 members
Designer invitation	Apply to the Founding 50 — program size of 50 designers
Maker invitation	Apply to Partner — seeking 15 Founding Makers
Geography	Membership open everywhere; first outreach through Leah's clients, Madison, then selected Chicago and Minneapolis conversations
Maker principle	Craft over volume; no sponsored placements or pay-to-play
Visual identity	Existing Patina Strata retained
Contact	hello@patina.cloud
Website and press background	https://patina.cloud · https://patina.cloud/press

Program sizes are caps or recruitment goals. They do not establish actual enrollment, accepted partners, availability remaining, or a future design-service footprint. Funding, revenue, traction, and a named partner roster are not included because no publishable evidence for those claims is part of this package.

Founder biographies

These are third-person editorial biographies, not quotations. They use the confirmed brand facts, the direction interview, and the founders' public background. "Middle West Studio" follows the studio's own current spelling.

Leah Kochaver — short

Leah Kochaver is Patina's Co-Founder, Design & Experience, and the founder of Middle West Studio. A practicing interior designer, she brings her understanding of people, rooms, and

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's designer-taught approach to furniture discovery.

Leah Kochaver — extended

Leah Kochaver leads Design & Experience at Patina and runs Middle West Studio, her interior-design practice in Wisconsin. Her background includes degrees in Fine Art and Communications, followed by interior-design study. After twelve years in Seattle, she returned to Wisconsin in 2018 and launched Middle West Studio in 2023. Her practice centers on understanding a client's life and translating that understanding into a home that feels personal and works well. At Patina, Leah brings this working designer's perspective to furniture discovery and the path from exploring independently to receiving more design guidance. She is building the platform with Kody Kochaver.

Source: Middle West Studio's "Meet Leah" biography, accessed 11 September 2026. The studio's opening and Patina's founding are separately documented facts; no shared founding-day anecdote is implied.

Kody Kochaver — short

Kody Kochaver is Patina's Co-Founder, Technology & Product. His work focuses on making complex systems easier to use. He is building Patina with Leah Kochaver so the tools around furniture discovery feel like part of the creative process.

Kody Kochaver — extended

Kody Kochaver leads Technology & Product at Patina. He has spent two decades making complex systems simpler to use, with work spanning Jydo, Blacktee, and Avidex. His approach begins with the experience of the person using a tool and how it can support the work they want to do. At Patina, that focus meets a problem close to the creative process: the tools available can feel sterile, leaving little room for the exploration and reconsideration that make design personal. Kody is building Patina alongside Leah Kochaver, combining his product perspective with her experience as a working interior designer.

Source: the confirmed messaging record, which verified Kody's personal site and LinkedIn on 10 September 2026. The same background is published in Patina's story, accessed 11 September 2026. The personal site could not be re-fetched during this research; job titles and employer dates are deliberately omitted.

Shared introduction

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Leah and Kody Kochaver founded Patina in Madison, Wisconsin, in 2023. Leah leads Design & Experience and brings the perspective of Middle West Studio. Kody leads Technology & Product. Together, they are developing a more personal way to discover furniture, guided by working designers and shaped with an early community of homeowners, designers, and makers.